

THE COLONIAL LEGACY & THE FOUNDATIONS OF THE REPUBLIC

THE BALANCE SHEET THE → HOW UNDERDEVELOPMENT WAS DEVELOPED → THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN → THE HUMAN BASELINE OF → THE STATE THAT WAS → THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

THE BALANCE SHEET THE REPUBLIC OPENED WITH

THE BALANCE SHEET THE REPUBLIC OPENED WITH

COLONIAL LIABILITY (ECONOMIC AND ADMINISTRATIVE)

MOVEMENT ASSET (POLITICAL) DEPENDENT, STAGNANT, FAMINE-PRONE ECONOMY

TESTED ALL-INDIA LEADERSHIP MASS ILLITERACY AND LOW LIFE EXPECTANCY

PARTY ORGANISED IN EVERY PROVINCE RENTIER AGRICULTURE, RISING LANDLESSNESS

DEMOCRACY, CIVIL LIBERTIES, SECULARISM APPARATUS BUILT FOR EXTRACTION AND

THREE DECADES OF PRACTISED ORGANISATION

HOW DID THE SECOND COLUMN CARRY THE FIRST WITHOUT

CORE CLAIM

COLONIAL LIABILITY (economic and administrative)

MOVEMENT ASSET (political) dependent, stagnant, famine-prone economy

tested all-India leadership mass illiteracy and low life expectancy

MECHANISM

party organised in every province rentier agriculture, rising landlessness

democracy, civil liberties, secularism apparatus built for extraction and order

three decades of practised organisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

CENTRAL QUESTION → how did the second column carry the first without collapsing?

ERROR TO AVOID → merging the columns and crediting the empire with Indian democracy.

CORE CLAIM

• COLONIAL LIABILITY (economic and administrative)

• MOVEMENT ASSET (political) dependent, stagnant, famine-prone economy

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MECHANISM

• party organised in every province rentier agriculture, rising landlessness

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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CENTRAL QUESTION → how did the second column carry the first without collapsing?

• ERROR TO AVOID → merging the columns and crediting the empire with Indian democracy.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ERROR TO AVOID → merging the columns and crediting the empire with Indian democracy.

01

STAGE 01

HOW UNDERDEVELOPMENT WAS DEVELOPED

HOW UNDERDEVELOPMENT WAS DEVELOPED

SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION WITH THE WORLD CAPITALIST SYSTEM SINCE THE

FORCED INTERNATIONAL DIVISION OF LABOUR

RAW MATERIALS OUT, MANUFACTURES IN

REAL CHANGE IN RAILWAYS, ADMINISTRATION, EDUCATION, FINANCE AND COMMUNICATIONS

BUT CHANGE OPERATING INSIDE A COLONIAL FRAME CRYSTALLISES A

POVERTY, DEPENDENCE AND SUBORDINATION REPRODUCED RATHER THAN GROWTH GENERATED

THE PHRASE DEVELOPMENT OF UNDERDEVELOPMENT BELONGS TO A. GUNDER

SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION with the world capitalist system since the 1750s

forced international division of labour: raw materials out, manufactures in

real change in railways, administration, education, finance and communications

but change operating INSIDE a colonial frame crystallises a dependent structure

poverty, dependence and subordination reproduced rather than growth generated

CORE CLAIM

• SUBORDINATE INTEGRATION with the world capitalist system since the 1750s

• forced international division of labour: raw materials out, manufactures in

MECHANISM

• real change in railways, administration, education, finance and communications

• but change operating INSIDE a colonial frame crystallises a dependent structure

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• poverty, dependence and subordination reproduced rather than growth generated

• ATTRIBUTION → the phrase development of underdevelopment belongs to A. Gunder Frank.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ATTRIBUTION → the phrase development of underdevelopment belongs to A. Gunder Frank.

02

STAGE 02

THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN ATTRIBUTED NUMBERS

THE AGRARIAN LEGACY IN ATTRIBUTED NUMBERS

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE PER CAPITA AGRICULTURAL PRODUCTION

FALLS ABOUT 14% BETWEEN 1901 AND 1941 PER CAPITA

FALLS FURTHER THAN TOTAL PRODUCTION LANDLESS AGRICULTURAL LABOURERS

ABOUT 13% IN 1871 RISING TO ABOUT 28% BY

REPORTED AS OVER 70% IN THE LOCAL TEXT

LANDLORDS, MONEYLENDERS, MERCHANTS AND THE COLONIAL REVENUE STATE

RACK-RENTING AND USURY ARE SAFER THAN INVESTMENT, SO STAGNATION

CORE CLAIM

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production

falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains

falls further than total production landless agricultural labourers

MECHANISM

about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s

reported as over 70% in the local text

STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

CORE CLAIM

• SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production

• falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains

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MECHANISM

• about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s

• reported as over 70% in the local text

• STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

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CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production	about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s	INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.
falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains	reported as over 70% in the local text	
falls further than total production landless agricultural labourers	STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state	

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE per capita agricultural production
- falls about 14% between 1901 and 1941 per capita foodgrains
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MECHANISM

- about 13% in 1871 rising to about 28% by 1951 land controlled by landlords by the 1940s
- reported as over 70% in the local text
- STRUCTURE → landlords, moneylenders, merchants and the colonial revenue state

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: INCENTIVE → rack-renting and usury are safer than investment, so stagnation is rational.

03

STAGE 03

THE HUMAN BASELINE OF 1951

THE HUMAN BASELINE OF 1951

SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 UNLESS STATED) ILLITERACY, ALL INDIANS

NEARLY 84 PER CENT ILLITERACY, WOMEN

ABOUT 92 PER CENT; ABOUT 8 LITERATE WOMEN IN

BARELY 32 YEARS FOR AN INDIAN BORN BETWEEN 1940

ABOUT 25 PER 1,000 PERSONS A YEAR INFANT MORTALITY

BETWEEN 175 AND 190 PER 1,000 LIVE BIRTHS

COLONIAL NEGLECT OF MASS, TECHNICAL AND FEMALE EDUCATION, NOT

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 unless stated) illiteracy, all Indians	barely 32 years for an Indian born between 1940 and 1951 death rate, 1941-50	CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.
nearly 84 per cent illiteracy, women	about 25 per 1,000 persons a year infant mortality	
about 92 per cent; about 8 literate women in every 100 life expectancy at birth	between 175 and 190 per 1,000 live births	

CORE CLAIM

- SOURCE-ATTRIBUTED VALUE (1951 unless stated) illiteracy, all Indians
- nearly 84 per cent illiteracy, women
- about 92 per cent; about 8 literate women in every 100 life expectancy at birth

MECHANISM

- barely 32 years for an Indian born between 1940 and 1951 death rate, 1941-50
- about 25 per 1,000 persons a year infant mortality
- between 175 and 190 per 1,000 live births

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUSE → colonial neglect of mass, technical and female education, not poverty alone.

04

STAGE 04

THE STATE THAT WAS KEPT RATHER THAN DISMANTLED

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INHERITED APPARATUS

AUTHORITARIAN CORE

REPRESSIVE LAWS FRAMED WITHOUT INDIAN DEMOCRATIC CONSENT

→ WIDE ARBITRARY POWER WITH CIVIL SERVANTS AND POLICE

→ COLLECTOR AND DISTRICT MAGISTRATE IN ONE OFFICE

LIBERAL FRAGMENTS

RULE OF LAW

INHERITED APPARATUS

AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent

→ wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

→ collector and district magistrate in one office

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INHERITED APPARATUS - AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent → wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police	→ collector and district magistrate in one office - LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law - relatively independent judiciary	→ press, speech and association tolerated in calm periods - REPUBLIC'S TASK → convert an instrument of order and extraction into one of development - THESIS → continuity with conversion, not rupture; that conversion is the real legacy problem.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law | relatively independent judiciary.

05

STAGE 05

THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

THREE FRANCHISES, ONE BREAK

AFTER 1919

ABOUT 3 PER CENT OF INDIANS COULD VOTE

LEGISLATURES WITH LITTLE POWER

AFTER 1935

ABOUT 15 PER CENT COULD VOTE

SUPREME POWER STILL WITH THE BRITISH

UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE

AFTER 1919	about 3 per cent of Indians could vote	legislatures with little power
AFTER 1935	about 15 per cent could vote	supreme power still with the British

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LIBERAL FRAGMENTS

ROLE OF LAW

INHERITED APPARATUS

AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent

→ wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

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CORE CLAIM

- INHERITED APPARATUS
- AUTHORITARIAN CORE → repressive laws framed without Indian democratic consent
- → wide arbitrary power with civil servants and police

MECHANISM

- → collector and district magistrate in one office
- LIBERAL FRAGMENTS → rule of law
- relatively independent judiciary

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- → press, speech and association tolerated in calm periods
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AFTER 1919	about 3 per cent of Indians could vote	legislatures with little power
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REPUBLIC	universal adult franchise	free and fair elections by right

CORE CLAIM

- AFTER 1919
- about 3 per cent of Indians could vote
- legislatures with little power
- AFTER 1935

MECHANISM

- about 15 per cent could vote
- supreme power still with the British
- universal adult franchise
- free and fair elections by right

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- COLONIAL PURPOSE → co-opt and weaken the national movement while keeping the reins
- UNINTENDED EFFECT → Indians gain practical experience of elections and elected organs
- THE BREAK → the republic replaced the colonial franchise; it did not widen it by degrees.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: THE BREAK → the republic replaced the colonial franchise; it did not widen it by degrees.

06

STAGE 06

MOVEMENT ASSETS CONVERTED INTO REPUBLICAN INSTITUTIONS

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NATIONAL MOVEMENT

RAJENDRA PRASAD

NO SINGLE REGION OR COMMUNITY

FIRST NEHRU CABINET OF FOURTEEN INCLUDES FIVE NON-CONGRESSMEN

→ B.R. AMBEDKAR CHAIRS THE DRAFTING COMMITTEE

ACCOMMODATIVE POLITICS; THREE DECADES OF ELECTIONS, ARGUMENT, ORGANISATION

ALL-INDIA SERVICES AND A NATIONAL ARMY ON MERIT, UNDER

LEADERSHIP → Nehru

→ Rajendra Prasad → no single region or community

→ BREADTH → first Nehru cabinet of fourteen includes five non-Congressmen

CORE CLAIM

- NATIONAL MOVEMENT
- LEADERSHIP → Nehru
- Rajendra Prasad → no single region or community

MECHANISM

- BREADTH → first Nehru cabinet of fourteen includes five non-Congressmen
- → B.R. Ambedkar chairs the Drafting Committee
- HABITS → accommodative politics; three decades of elections, argument, organisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONVERSION → all-India services and a national army on merit, under civilian control
- LATER COST → the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LATER COST → the same dominance becomes the Congress system whose decay is a later topic.

07

STAGE 07

FOUR PRESSURES IN THE SAME MONTHS

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COMMUNAL VIOLENCE

REFUGEE MOVEMENT, KILLING, MINORITY INSECURITY

TELANGANA INSURGENCY

ARMED COMMUNIST CHALLENGE INSIDE THE NEW REPUBLIC

PRINCELY INTEGRATION

MORE THAN 560 UNITS TO ACCEDE, MERGE AND DEMOCRATISE

CONTESTED FRONTIER

CORE CLAIM

- COMMUNAL VIOLENCE → refugee movement, killing, minority insecurity
- TELANGANA INSURGENCY → armed communist challenge inside the new republic
- PRINCELY INTEGRATION → more than 560 units to accede, merge and democratise

MECHANISM

- CONTESTED FRONTIER → fighting and an international reference in Kashmir
- PLUS → a divided army and a divided treasury inherited on the first day
- METHOD → secular reassurance + coercive capacity + reconciliation, democracy not suspended

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CONSEQUENCE → the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONSEQUENCE → the constitutional preference for a strong centre and emergency provisions.

LEADERSHIP → Nehru

Rajendra Prasad → no single region or community

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08

STAGE 08

READING THE TWO MOST MISUSED FIGURES

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WHAT IT IS

WHAT IT IS NOT NEARLY SIX MILLION

REFUGEES ENTERING INDIA

TOTAL DISPLACEMENT BOTH WAYS ROUGHLY 500,000 DEAD

CHANDRA'S ESTIMATE

SETTLED OR AGREED SCHOLARSHIP

WEST FLOW

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
WHAT IT IS	total displacement both ways roughly 500,000 dead	WEST FLOW → largely one movement in 1947; land vacated; resettled substantially by 1951
WHAT IT IS NOT nearly six million	Chandra's estimate	EAST FLOW → continuous migration from East Bengal; little land; urban underclass formed
refugees ENTERING India	settled or agreed scholarship	SAFE SENTENCE → name the author, mark the direction, record that other scholarship differs.

CORE CLAIM

WHAT IT IS

WHAT IT IS NOT nearly six million

refugees ENTERING India

MECHANISM

total displacement both ways roughly 500,000 dead

Chandra's estimate

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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

WEST FLOW → largely one movement in 1947; land vacated; resettled substantially by 1951

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SAFE SENTENCE → name the author, mark the direction, record that other scholarship differs.

09

STAGE 09

FROM ASSASSINATION TO THE LIFTED BAN

FROM ASSASSINATION TO THE LIFTED BAN

JAN 1948

AFTER A FAST BY GANDHI, RS 550 MILLION PAID

30 JAN 1948

GANDHI ASSASSINATED BY NATHURAM GODSE

COMMUNALISM RETREATS SHARPLY

RASHTRIYA SWAYAMSEVAK SANGH BANNED; LEADERS AND FUNCTIONARIES ARRESTED

JUN 1949

JAN 1948 → after a fast by Gandhi, Rs 550 million paid to Pakistan (assets)

→

30 JAN 1948 → Gandhi assassinated by Nathuram Godse → communalism retreats sharply

→

IMMEDIATE → Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh banned; leaders and functionaries arrested

→

JUN 1949 → Nehru records a preference for fewer bans and detentions

→

JULY 1949 → ban lifted on accepted conditions: written and published constitution, cultural activity only

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MECHANISM

JUN 1949 → Nehru records a preference for fewer bans and detentions

JULY 1949 → ban lifted on accepted conditions: written and published constitution, cultural activity only, no violence or secrecy, loyalty to flag and

Constitution, democratic internal organisation

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

READING → proscription used and then withdrawn on terms, not permanent suppression.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: READING → proscription used and then withdrawn on terms, not permanent suppression.

10

STAGE 10

INSURRECTION CONVERTED INTO OPPOSITION

INSURRECTION CONVERTED INTO OPPOSITION

LATE 1946

COMMUNIST-LED PEASANT STRUGGLE DEVELOPS IN TELANGANA INSIDE HYDERABAD STATE

FEB 1948

B.T. RANADIVE LINE DECLARES INDEPENDENCE FALSE AND ADOPTS ARMED

INSURGENCY CONTAINED BY THE STATE WHILE THE POLITICAL DOOR

TELANGANA STRUGGLE CALLED OFF; THE PARLIAMENTARY PATH IS ADOPTED

PARTY LEGALISED EVERYWHERE; LEADERS AND CADRES RELEASED; ELECTIONS CONTESTED

LATE 1946 → Communist-led peasant struggle develops in Telangana inside Hyderabad state

→

FEB 1948 → B.T. Ranadive line declares independence false and adopts armed struggle

→

1948-51 → insurgency contained by the state while the political door is kept open

→

MID-1951 → Telangana struggle called off; the parliamentary path is adopted

→

THEN → party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested

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MECHANISM

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CORE CLAIM

- LATE 1946 → Communist-led peasant struggle develops in Telangana inside Hyderabad state
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MECHANISM

- 1948-51 → insurgency contained by the state while the political door is kept open
- MID-1951 → Telangana struggle called off; the parliamentary path is adopted

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- THEN → party legalised everywhere; leaders and cadres released; elections contested
- LESSON → the armed challenge was defeated and the party was not abolished.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LESSON → the armed challenge was defeated and the party was not abolished.

11

STAGE 11

FOUR DOMAINS, TWO DATES AND ONE COMPLETED MAP

FOUR DOMAINS, TWO DATES AND ONE COMPLETED MAP

INTEGRATION, CONSTITUTION 26 NOV 1949

26 JAN 1950, UNIVERSAL ADULT FRANCHISE

STRONG-CENTRE BIAS AND UNRESOLVED REGIONAL QUESTIONS

PLANNED, STATE-LED DEVELOPMENT WITH A PUBLIC-SECTOR CORE AND LAND-REFORM

SLOW GROWTH AND LAND REFORM LARGELY UNIMPLEMENTED

FROM ABOUT 84 PER CENT ILLITERACY TO DELIBERATE SCIENTIFIC

ELITE-FIRST EXPANSION; PRIMARY AND FEMALE EDUCATION LAG BADLY

POLITY → integration, Constitution 26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950, universal adult franchise

→

LIMIT: strong-centre bias and unresolved regional questions

→

ECONOMY → planned, state-led development with a public-sector core and land-reform law

→

LIMIT: slow growth and land reform largely unimplemented

→

EDUCATION → from about 84 per cent illiteracy to deliberate scientific and technical investment

CORE CLAIM

- POLITY → integration, Constitution 26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950, universal adult franchise
- LIMIT: strong-centre bias and unresolved regional questions
- ECONOMY → planned, state-led development with a public-sector core and land-reform law
- LIMIT: slow growth and land reform largely unimplemented

MECHANISM

- EDUCATION → from about 84 per cent illiteracy to deliberate scientific and technical investment
- LIMIT: elite-first expansion; primary and female education lag badly
- INT. REL. → non-alignment and Asian solidarity; Pondicherry 1954; Goa 17 December 1961
- LIMIT: limited hard power

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- TWO DATES → independence 15 Aug 1947
- republic 26 Jan 1950; the 2026 parade is the 77th precisely because 1950 counts as the first
- DO NOT CONFUSE → Operation Vijay (Goa, Dec 1961) with Operation Polo (Hyderabad, Sep 1948).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DO NOT CONFUSE → Operation Vijay (Goa, Dec 1961) with Operation Polo (Hyderabad, Sep 1948).

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE COLONIAL ECONOMY WAS STRUCTURALLY DEPENDENT — COMMERCIALISED AGRICULTURE

GROWTH, ARRESTED INDUSTRIALISATION, AND A STATE GEARED TO EXTRACTION

LANDLESS AGRICULTURAL LABOUR HAD RISEN FROM ABOUT 13% (1871)

THE PARADOX OF 1947 IS THAT INDIA WAS ECONOMICALLY

THE MOST CONFIDENT — BECAUSE THE FREEDOM STRUGGLE HAD

CHANDRA'S ARGUMENT

THE NATIONAL MOVEMENT " INDIGENISED DEMOCRACY ," GIVING

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- The colonial economy was structurally dependent — commercialised agriculture without productivity
- growth, arrested industrialisation, and a state geared to extraction, not development.
- Landless agricultural labour had risen from about 13% (1871) to 28% (1951) , a marker of colonial agrarian distress.
- CAUTION: The paradox of 1947 is that India was economically among the poorest nations yet politically among

ADVANCED DEBATE

- the most confident — because the freedom struggle had already built a democratic, participatory political culture.
- CAUTION: Chandra's argument: the national movement " indigenised democracy ," giving
- the new institutions a legitimacy that most decolonising states lacked.
- Four simultaneous threats — communal violence, the Telangana insurgency, princely-state integration, and

LEGACY / NUANCE

- the Kashmir war — could have Balkanised or militarised the state.
- The leadership chose secularism plus force plus reconciliation : containing riots, banning and then rehabilitating
- the RSS, integrating states, and defeating the Communist insurgency while keeping the CPI legal.
- CAUTION: The decision to adopt universal adult franchise at once — in a poor, largely illiterate

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels

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